
Topic 1: Social psychology

Topic overview

Students must show understanding that social psychology is about aspects of human behaviour that involve the individual's relationship to other persons, groups and society, including cultural influences on behaviour.

Individual differences and developmental psychology must be considered when learning about obedience, prejudice, personality and cultural influences on social behaviour.

Subject content	What students need to learn:
1.1 Content	Obedience
	1.1.1 Theories of obedience, including agency theory and social impact theory.
	1.1.2 Research into obedience, including Milgram's research into obedience and three of his variation studies: Rundown Office Block (Experiment 10), Telephonic instructions (Experiment 7), Ordinary man gives orders (Experiment 13) as they demonstrate situational factors that encourage dissent.
	1.1.3 Factors affecting obedience and dissent/resistance to obedience, including individual differences (personality and gender), situation and culture.
	Prejudice
	1.1.4 Explanations and research into prejudice, including social identity theory (Tajfel and Turner, 1979, 1986) and realistic conflict theory (Sherif, 1966).
	1.1.5 Factors affecting prejudice (and discrimination), including individual differences (personality), situation and culture.
	1.1.6 Individual differences in obedience/prejudice • Obedience is affected by personality. • Prejudice can have an explanation linked to personality.
	1.1.7 Developmental psychology in obedience/prejudice • Obedience can be affected by gender and culture, which come from environmental effects. • Prejudice can be affected by culture, which comes from environmental effects.